Rick van Lieshout

CTO · Tech Lead · Software Architect

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

CTO, software architect and engineering leader with a track record of scaling engineering organisations and delivering business-critical platforms. Grew the internal engineering team from 5 to 30 engineers (peak operation of 50+ including offshore) while leading the architectural transformation from a legacy system to a modern cloud-native, event-driven platform on Kubernetes. Combines hands-on technical depth with a people-first leadership approach, developing engineers and engineering leaders while using technology pragmatically to solve business problems.

KEY HIGHLIGHTS

- CTO at Frontliners: technical strategy, architecture and engineering leadership of the organisation.
- Transformed release delivery from a scheduled release every two months to daily CI/CD using containers, Kubernetes and automation.
- Grew engineering from 5 to 30 internal engineers, building multiple teams and developing three chapter leads to take on direct team leadership responsibilities. Upskilled several people/teams to support the organisation's evolving technical direction.
- Led TFX into production across international Royal Den Hartogh operations, progressively replacing legacy capabilities.
- Enabled new users to contribute meaningfully from day one through guided workflows, role-based permissions and human checks for safety-critical dangerous-goods operations; previously onboarding took weeks.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Chief Technology Officer | Frontliners (Inforit) *| 2016 - 2026 - CTO since 2022*

Responsible for technical strategy, software architecture and engineering leadership. Led the transition from a legacy platform with significant scalability and maintainability challenges to a modern cloud-native, event-driven architecture.

- Owned the entire technical roadmap and partnered with the CPO on integrated planning of functional and technical priorities, balancing short-term business goals with longer-term technical investment.
- Led hiring, performance reviews and career development across engineering teams, coaching engineers (personal & tech) and introducing chapter leads to distribute leadership as the organisation grew.
- Coached engineers through technical and behavioural challenges, combining constructive feedback, mentoring and sustained support to achieve meaningful improvements in performance and collaboration.
- Directed modernization using Kafka, Kubernetes and Domain-Driven Design. Independent external technical reviews supported architectural improvement; TFX is in production and rolling out internationally.
- Increased delivery predictability through feature flags, rapid day-one patches and repeatable automated releases, replacing extensive manual runbooks for routine updates.

Career progression: Software Architect (2018) → Lead Software Architect (2019) → Tech Lead (2020) → CTO (2022).

Key technologies: .NET, TypeScript, React, Kubernetes, Kafka, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Elasticsearch, Supabase, ArgoCD, Terraform, Vault, Keycloak

Research & Applied Machine Learning (side initiative) / *2019*

Contributed to research into antisense oligonucleotide therapy in collaboration with external researchers. Applied machine learning and data-analysis techniques to biological datasets using Python and Scala, exploring predictive modelling and sequence-related analysis.

Developer – Solidwinds / *2015–2016*

Architected and began implementing a scalable metrics collection system for wind-turbine location scouting. Gathered data from IoT-scale sensor towers and aggregated it to assess the profitability and sustainability of potential wind-farm locations.

Hanflex – HAN University of Applied Sciences / *2015–2018*

Taught professional English and cloud technology (Docker). Gave demonstrations and organised student-facing events, including introductory classes in Java, .NET and PostgreSQL, and outreach to prospective students.

Founder & Freelance Developer / *2006–2019*

Built websites, custom software and technical solutions for individuals, local organisations and small businesses. Developed experience in requirements gathering, solution design, customer communication and long-term maintenance; several solutions remained in use for years.

SKILLS & TECHNOLOGIES

Leadership & strategy: Engineering organisations, roadmaps, budgets, hiring, compensation and performance management, vendors, stakeholder management, coaching.

Architecture & delivery: Domain-Driven Design, event-driven systems, distributed architecture, microservices, cloud-native modernisation, CI/CD, feature flags, observability, Infrastructure as Code.

Technology: .NET, TypeScript, React, Kubernetes, Docker, Kafka, Azure, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, ArgoCD, Terraform, Atlantis, Vault, Keycloak, Linux.

AI & Developer Productivity: AI-assisted development; Hermes, OpenAI, Claude, Copilot and Codex; developer tooling and automation; prompt engineering and workflow design (n8n, scheduled jobs).

EDUCATION & TRAINING

HBO ICT / Software Engineering | HAN University of Applied Sciences | 2014–2018.
Graduated with an average of 8.0/10; first-year average 8.3/10.

Selected training: Domain-Driven Design (Vijfhart); Young Executive Program (De Baak); hiring and interviewing (icm); conversation and de-escalation (TIJDwinst); Kubernetes on Azure (AKS, NobleProg).

OPEN SOURCE

Significant portion of personal work published as open source. Projects range from developer tooling to full applications and infrastructure-related work. Available on GitHub: github.com/Mastermindzh and rickvanlieshout.com.